

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 3

♥ 9 2

♦ A Q 10 4

♣ A J 7 3

♠ A K J 8 6 2

♥ K 7 4

♦ 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ 7 5

♥ Q J 10 8 5 3

♦ K J 7

♣ 10 9

♠ Q 4

♥ A 6

♦ 9 8 6 5 3

♣ Q 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

You must eliminate one loser and the easiest one will be the ♥ which you can ruff in dummy. However, West's ♥9 looks a little ominous, particularly since East apparently has some length in the suit. Presumably you played the ♥A on the first trick. Next lead the ♥6 from dummy, hoping West can't (or doesn't) ruff. He plays the ♥2. Win the ♥K and play your ♥4, ruffing with dummy's ♠Q. West is out of ♥s, but can't over-ruff. Now pull trumps and set up one ♣ trick. You lose 2 ♣s and a ♦, just as expected.

Ruffing with the ♠Q might cost a trick if the ♠s split 4-1 and West did not have a doubleton ♥. But you need to stay flexible and make your decisions based on what you see happening at the table. In this deal, after West signalled high-low in ♥s it was logical to play him for a doubleton.

An easy one. You bid 1♠. Partner responds 1NT.

What is your next bid?

You're going to rebid your 6-card ♠ suit, but how high? The usual guideline is to bid 2♠ with 13-15 points, but jump to 3♠ with 16-18 points. You come in just over the line so you bid 3♠. Partner puts it in game.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q, West playing ♥9.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 7 4 3
 ♥ A K 6 3
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A K 6

♠ 10 6 2

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 8 3 2



♠ A K Q J

♥ Q 7 2

♦ 10 9 6

♣ J 7 4

♠ 9 5

♥ 8 4

♦ A K Q J 5 4

♣ Q 10 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Dbl	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			

4 ♠ by East

would be eliminated - if North didn't over-ruff. But you know that North is going to over-ruff. So don't ruff it, discard dummy's ♣ 6 instead. Later you can ruff your ♣ loser in dummy.

If you had ruffed, North would have over-ruffed. And you would still have a ♣ loser. You don't have to worry about a fourth ♦ lead because you can ruff in your hand higher than any card North might ruff with.

When responding to a takeout double use these guidelines:
 0-8 points: bid a suit cheaply
 9-11 points: bid a suit with a jump
 12 or more points: cue-bid the opponent's suit

With 13 points you cue-bid 2 ♦. Partner says 2 ♥.

You are forced to game, now you must find a suit. Partner suggested ♥s, you suggest ♠s. Partner agrees ♠s and bids the game.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ Q. North plays ♦ 8 then ♦ 2.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ Q. North plays ♦ 8 then ♦ 2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

If you could ruff that ♦ then one of your ♦ losers would be eliminated - if North didn't over-ruff. But you know that North is going to over-ruff. So don't ruff it, discard dummy's ♣ 6 instead. Later you can ruff your ♣ loser in dummy.